Darcy's Cinematic Life

By Christa Crewdson

DARCY: **(Pg 97-98)** I'm Darcy. Some people think I'm . . . .

MOM: Darling.

DARCY: I like to think of myself as a highly creative citizen of the universe. And in addition to my above average intelligence, I have what people call...

MOM: An overactive imagination.

DARCY: I prefer to think of it as my mind creating little movies in my head. You see, I get to thinking of something and my mind just takes over. Thoughts come to life, right before my eyes. It's...

MOM: An overactive imagination.

DARCY: That's my Mom. I also have a ...

BROTHER: Dork.

DARCY: Little bother. And a nemesis, an arch enemy ... Liza.

LIZA: Liza.

DARCY: Liza. Who pronounces it that way? Liza and I have had issues since kindergarten. She's one of the perfect people. In other words she's a ...

MOM: Nice girl. Why don't you invite her over?

DARCY: Like in any good story, there is also a true love. Chad. I have been in love with Chad since preschool. But he, well...

CHAD: Hi, Katie.

DARCY: **(Pg 100-101)** It's Darcy. He doesn't really feel the same way. *(Beat)* Every school day is the same. It's like that movie Groundhog Day. Liza is mean to me, Chad ignores me and I try to find ways to amuse myself in this institution of monotony. *(Beat)* Anyway, I have to confess that for the first time in my life I am grappling with a problem. A ... ugh ... teen problem. The impending class trip to the art museum. To a semi-outcast like myself, it is a major deal. *(Bell rings)* Homeroom.

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INTRODUCTION

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LIZA: **(Pg 101-102)** Is this field trip tomorrow going to be lame or what?

DARCY: Actually, the Art Institute is one of the most famous museums in the world. It houses many famous works including Georges Seurat's A Sunday on La Grande Latte.

LIZA: Who? La what?

CHAD: Hey, were you guys talking about that painting with the dots? That painting is awesome. It's pretty tripped out. Art is cool.

DARCY: Ok, I am aware that Chad is not an intellectual, and I am perfectly content with that. I am smart enough for the two of us. The sound of his voice invokes a movie-one I have seen many times before . . .

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(Flash to prom scene where Darcy and Chad are dancing)

CHAD: Darcy, these past four years have been the best of my life.

DARCY: Mine too!

CHAD: I want to give you this. *(Hands her a ring.)*

DARCY: Oh Chad, it's beautiful. . . . . to the future our wedding. *(Hums wedding processional as they proceed down the aisle)* Then twins! *(pantomime babies in arms)* And we spend our twilight years sipping lemonade on the porch. In our home, home, home. *(Bell rings)*

LIZA: *(Breaking into Darcy's daydreams, she speaks snarkily)* Homeroom is over, Darcy!

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DARCY: Science class. This is the one place I have a little clout because of my superior knowledge in this particular field. I am always flooded with offers of...

LIZA: Will you be my lab partner?

TEACHER: Projects are due today as you know.

LIZA: *(To Darcy)* You did the project, right?

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DARCY: I know I'm being used, but it might secure me a seat on that bus. *(Insert Law and Order Theme Song)*

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BAILIFF: **(Pg 106-107)** Case number 261, Darcy versus Liza.

LAWYER: Ladies and gentlemen of the jury, I shall prove beyond a shadow of a doubt that Liza has caused years of emotional suffering for my client, Darcy. Although Darcy is an extremely successful, well-adjusted young woman, she is here today to stand up for all highly intelligent, above average, citizens of the universe that are tormented by the perfect people! I call Liza to the stand.

LAWYER: How do you know Darcy?

LIZA: We go to school together.

LAWYER: Haven't you been lab partners? Didn't you take credit for work she did.

LIZA: I helped!

LAWYER: What were the projects you helped with?

LIZA: The one with the thingy.

LAWYER: Isn't it true that you were hanging out with your friends while Darcy did all the work? Isn't it true that you have done nothing but torment Darcy since kindergarten?

LIZA: *(Defiantly)* NO!

LAWYER. Isn't it true that inside you are an empty, insecure person, and that's why you torment others-to make yourself feel better? Isn't it? Isn't it?!!!!!

LIZA: *(Liza is crushed by the truth – She breaks)* Yes, yes, it's all true!

LAWYER: I rest my case. *(Bell rings)*

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DARCY: **(Pg 103-106)** T-minus 22 hours and counting until the field trip. As I stand upon the precipice of the school curb, I await my next horror: the dreaded clothes shopping with mom!

MOM: How was your day? Anything new?

DARCY: The mall. The most horrific place on earth. I would rather travel 100 miles to Indiana to

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shop rather than come here where everyone shops. With my luck I always run into ...

MOM: Isn't that your friend Liza?

DARCY: Mom, she's not my friend.

MOM: Darcy, she's walking this way, it's rude not to say hello. Hello, Liza.

DARCY: Well, we really have to go. Right mom?

MOM: Bye. Nice to see you. *(To Darcy)* I don't know what your problem is with her. She seems like such a nice person. Oh! Look at this!

DARCY: Mom's idea of fashion is .. .is ... well...even my superior vocabulary can't find the right word, so I'll use my little brother's favorite word "dorky." If she had her way, I'd be all buttoned up and in plaid or some other monstrosity. Cut to the first scene in the next movie - The Mom Fashion Show . . . . *(Walks the runway in very nerdy clothes with lots of attitude. A song plays throughout.)*

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DARCY: T-minus 18 hours to the field trip. Dinner -- "a time where families sit down together to eat and try to make their dull, boring lives sound interesting." I wish my family was one of those loud families in the movies where everyone is animated, and emotions fly around the room. Now that would be exciting!

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(Family is a loud, Sopranos-like boisterous family.)

DAD: This pasta is perfect!

MOM: Of course, it is. It's Mama's recipe. God rest her soul.

DAD: So, guess who sold the Thompson house today? Pete Piker did. I was so close to selling that worthless piece of ...

MOM: Mario! Watch your language. The children!

BROTHER: I've heard it all before.

DAD: Where? I bet that little weasel friend of yours Benito says stuff like that.

DARCY: Benito is cute.

DAD: Cute? If I ever see you so much as look at that no good ...

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DARCY: I'll look at who I want!

DAD: Oh no you won't! Not as long as you live under my roof!

DARCY: Well maybe I'll move out!

DAD: You're 13! Where are you going to go? *(Alarm clock rings, waking Darcy)*

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DARCY: **(Pg 107-108)** T-minus 3 hours until the trip. Morning. Mornings around here are pretty typical. Lots of rushing, complaining, scarfing down food and running out the door.

MOM: *(To Darcy)* Honey, go back upstairs and put on that nice outfit we bought yesterday. For heaven's sake you're going to the Art Institute today! You need to dress appropriately!

DARCY: Mom, no one else is going to be dressed up. I'll look ridiculous! . . . . *(a stern look from Mom)* Fine! *(as she is changing)* I've always loved those movies where there's a scene that takes place in the morning and introduces you to the quaint little town. *(She opens the door and steps outside)* I wish that mornings were like that around here.

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(Music plays . . . Perhaps Belle's opening song from Beauty and the Beast or Good Morning, Baltimore from Hairspray)

TOWNSPERSON 1: **(Pg 109)** Morning, Darcy

TOWNSPERSON 2: Be sure to tell your mother I said hello!

TOWNSPERSON 3: You sure do look pretty today, Darcy!

DARCY: *(Music stops)* Then there's reality.

LIZA: *(Bumps into Darcy on purpose; sarcastically)* Sorry, I didn't see you. Oh, did you buy that cute little outfit at the mall yesterday?

DARCY: Well, at least I made an effort to look like I am going to a museum, not a Britney Spears concert.

LIZA: Well, excuse us. I guess we don't know what to wear to go stand in front of a painting and look at a bunch of dots!

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DARCY: **(Pg 109-110)** T-minus 13 minutes until the trip. I can't do it. I have to think of some way out! I could cut off my leg with a pencil. No, that would take too much time. I could fake a demonic possession. No, too Hollywood. I have to face the music, I'm going to have to get on that bus. *(Bus doors hisses open)* Oh yellow nemesis of mine. I have been awaiting your cruel fate. Ok, this is it. I have exactly 8.5 seconds to survey the seating choices. *(DARCY stands in the aisle surveying the seats and the kids. She characterizes her options in pantomime)* Choice one-Lenny the loner. Choice two-Renee the mooch. Choice three-Mr. Donovan, a chaperone. *(She sits down gingerly on the very edge of the bus seat and looks miserable.)* Finally the museum! *(Bus door hisses open)* I've been here many times so I know exactly where all the exhibits are. I'll try to share some of my knowledge of art with my fellow classmates. *(to Classmate while gazing in awe at a painting)* Monet attempted to capture conditions of light and atmosphere with bright colors and lively, broken brush strokes.

STUDENT 1: I wonder where the snack bar is? *(Darcy moves to the next painting)*

DARCY: Van Gogh's self-portraits reveal the profound insecurity and frustration of a gifted man!

STUDENT 2: I think this is the dude that cut off his ear.

DARCY: I give up. *(Notices Chad by himself looking at a painting – She gathers her courage and walks over to him and gazes at the painting)*

CHAD: I wonder who this is a picture of?

DARCY: No artist has dominated the 20th century in the way Pablo Picasso has. His subjects were society's outcasts, lonely figures. Maybe no one understands him. Maybe he feels like he was born during the wrong time or place. He's just waiting to find where he belongs.

CHAD: *(In awe)* You get all that from just looking at the painting?

DARCY: *(Making a true connection with Chad)* Kind of. That's just my interpretation though. Why do you think he looks so sad?

CHAD: *(They lock eyes, and the rest of the world disappears)* Maybe he wants to be alone, so he can be himself. Maybe he's sick of everyone always expecting him to be their friend,

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to be nice, to be funny, to be perfect. Maybe being everything to everyone makes him really lonely. *(The moment is interrupted by…)*

LIZA: *(Enters and speaks in a flirty voice)* Hi, Chad!

CHAD: Hey. Seeing some good stuff?

LIZA: I am now.

DARCY: Ugh. *(Darcy gags)*

LIZA: Did you say something?

DARCY: No, I have a hairball, that's all. Better move, I don't want to cough it up on you!

LIZA: Gross. Let's go. *(She and Chad exit)*

DARCY: **(Pg 112)** Cut to a scene from an adventure movie. I play the hero and Chad, the helpless lad who has been caught in the clutches of the evil dragon. I have to slay the mighty beast in order to save him. But ***she*** is the mighty beast. *(pantomime fight scene with Liza in slow motion)* I slay the dragon and free the lad who is eternally grateful. We ride off into the sunset to ... *(Her daydream is interrupted by . . .)*

TEACHER: Darcy, the bus is leaving!

DARCY: Right, the bus. Just as bad as a dragon. This is one beast I can't conquer. I know my fate. Doomed forever to sit alone or with . . . *(Again surveys her options and characterizes her options in pantomime)* Ugh.

CHAD: Hey! *(He waves her over to sit next to him) (Darcy beams)*

DARCY: *(to audience)* There will come a time when you believe everything is finished. That will be the beginning!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2009 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2014 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier – MS
2020 National Qualifier – MS
2021 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier – MS
2024 National Qualifier – MS
2025 National Qualifier – MS
CO State Qualifier
IL State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

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